Contents

Questions 1

- Read the Course Syllabus
  - Check that you will have access to the three films in the Course Materials section.
- Read the Preface to the Course, which consists of sections:
  1. Genesis of the Course: Getting Perspective on Mind Control
  2. Shaping the Container
  3. What We Will Be Exploring
  4. An Arc of Stories and Lenses
     - You may delay reading the parts on the tales for weeks 2, 3, and 4, which will be repeated as part of the notes on the tale of the week.
- Read the Notes on *Notes from the Underground*.
  - This contains a section titled "Tale 1: Notes from the Underground", which exactly repeats the subsection by that name in section 4 of the preface.
- Watch "Notes from the Underground", one-man show starring Larry Cedar, free on YouTube.

Questions

Here are some questions that may help guide your reflection. They are all about the protagonist in *Notes from the Underground*, who is not given a name in the story, but is conventionally referred to as the Underground Man.

Concrete Questions about the Underground Man

- What is his situation?
- How did he get into it?
- What was his dilemma?
- What about his personality might have caused him difficulty?

More Abstract/Subjective Questions in Preface Section on *Notes from the Underground* and Human Outlier Analysis

- How is the protagonist unusual in the society in which they live, and how are they trying to influence that society?
- Do you sympathize with the protagonist and his plight? What about the other characters?
- Can we usefully separate out the dysfunction from the creative insight?
- What does the protagonist see about society that those around him do not see?